

MADISON: Okay. Okay, do you want to try to press play then?

LISA: Yes.

MADISON: Okay. When was the last time you watched this? Did you watch it when you were putting all of these in Drive?

LISA: Just the beginning of it, and I was shocked by how southern my accent was.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: But I have not watched the whole thing, no.

MADISON: Okay. Oh, there's Stumpy sneezing. Okay, um. Okay, you have it pulled up?

LISA: Yep.

MADISON: Okay. I'll count us down and then after one, let's press play.

LISA: Okay.

MADISON: And I think it's fine if it's not perfectly synced, it's just so I can see what you're describing.

LISA: --(coughs)--Okay, sorry. Okay.

MADISON: And I'm, I'm not going to play audio on my end, so.

LISA: [00:01:00] Oh, okay. Okay.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: I can turn mine up a little. Okay.

MADISON: Okay. Three, two, one. So do you want to start describing it?

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: Or you could say like, the date.

LISA: Yeah. So this is April 12th, 1997. It says 9:40 p.m. Uh, this is in Oxford, North Carolina, where your dad and I were living out on a fifty-seven acre farm. And uh, we had been waiting for this mare to have her baby.

1997 LISA: Put your light off, Kevin.

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: I'm bossing him around because I'm using an old, old timey video recorder and the light was making my zoom, [00:02:00] my, my focus.

1997 LISA: --(??)--or I did, have her baby while we were at the auction, and it's night and Kevin swore she was going to have it in the morning.

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: I got the time on it.

LISA: So we went, ironically, to a humane society auction.

1997 LISA: --(??)--And she wasn't doing anything.

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: Actually, I actually left the auction to come see her. Got a pretty little star on his face.

KEVIN: --(??)--

LISA: Your, your dad was very excited about this foal.

1997 LISA: He looks really light in the back.

KEVIN: He's a light, I don't know if he may be a buckskin--

MADISON: --Because he wanted him to be a buckskin, right?

LISA: Yeah, he wanted him to be a buckskin.

1997 LISA: [00:03:00] Oh. Aw.

LISA: But he ended up, and I don't, I can't remember this video if we can tell how bad his leg is, but he had--

1997 LISA: --yeah--

LISA: --a deformed leg in the front. We ended up taking him to N.C. (North Carolina) State vet school and they casted him, put him in a cast while that leg grew--

1997 LISA: --when I was drying him, when you ran in the house. I dried him really good. Hey, listen to his lungs.

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --(??)--sounded really congested.

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: She was chewing on his angel feet.

LISA: Oh, I love their angel feet, that little membrane on their feet--

1997 LISA: Let me ask you something--

MADISON: --(??)--

1997 LISA: We got out of the car and tried to get up--

KEVIN: --she had half the foal out, you went to get the dogs and I wanted to make sure, I didn't know how long she had been in labor. So I checked to make sure she wasn't strained and she had like two more contractions and it was out.

1997 LISA: [00:04:00] So she was trying to get up.

KEVIN: No, she was in the middle of contractions. She was trying to see what's going on probably. She already had half the foal out of her.

LISA: So I said she had half the foal out of her when we pulled up, pulled in.

KEVIN: Missed it by five minutes.

1997 LISA: Oh my goodness.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Missed it by 5 minutes.

MADISON: Do you remember, because you start saying in the video you really wanted to see her foal, do you remember?

LISA: Yeah, yeah. I had never seen one before.

MADISON: Yeah.

--(ringing)--

LISA: We missed it by five minutes, he said. We left at 8:30 and then I started the video at 9:40 p.m. So, Chloe's the best mare, though. She really was the best horse.

1997 LISA: --hand(??), but where's my--

LISA: --you can see her placenta hanging.

1997 LISA: Where's my zoom?

MADISON: Oh, I don't think I saw her--

1997 LISA: --look for it up here--

MADISON: Why was she a good mare?

KEVIN: Find the light.

LISA: Say what?

MADISON: Why was she a good mare?

LISA: [00:05:00] Oh, just a very, very kind, very sweet--

1997 LISA: --yeah--

LISA: --calm.

1997 LISA: I'm supposed to have enough, but maybe I need to get closer.

KEVIN: Yeah, you might.

LISA: I bought this video camera for just this event. --(laughs)--

MADISON: Oh, I didn't know that.

LISA: Yes. So I'm asking your dad where the zoom is. I don't think I had ever used it.

MADISON: Yeah. And I think--

LISA: I was so excited.

MADISON: Is that the camera that you ended up using for like all the other videos?

LISA: Yes, yeah.

1997 LISA: Oh, she's not gonna step on him, is she?

LISA: --(laughs)--They get so close!

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: They walk all around them and you know, she's not always looking down, but they, they, he told me, your dad told me they just, they know where they are.

1997 LISA: Chloe, you're blocking my view, baby. Chloe--

LISA: [00:06:00] --yeah--

1997 LISA: --you're killing it for me, darling.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Blocking my view.

1997 LISA: Chloe, I want you to know I put six. No, I'm talking about, --(laughs)-- tell him it's okay, honey.

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: Yeah.

LISA: --(laughs)--

KEVIN: --(??)--

LISA: He's asking me to come around because--

1997 LISA: --(??)-- tell Chloe I had to put six muddy dogs in the house--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --without wiping their feet.

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: Now she's got a piece of placenta on her head, Chloe does.

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Your dad's cleaning his umbilical cord right now.

1997 LISA: Doesn't sound congested to you, does he?

LISA: Because those can get infected, that's really bad.

MADISON: But it's already--

LISA: --foals--

MADISON: --cut or did she like chew it?

1997 LISA: --a little buckskin colt!--

LISA: Yeah, a lot of times it just detaches when the mare spins around. [00:07:00] They don't, they don't have to cut them usually. It's just nature.

1997 LISA: Hey, girl!

LISA: Oh, this is much clearer, he's so cute.

MADISON: Mhmm.

1997 LISA: It's okay, all that matters is that you had a healthy baby.

LISA: --(laughs)--My southern accent. Being a nurse,--

1997 LISA: --the medicine bag, the bag with the umbilical tape and the--

LISA: I even had a, I had a bag ready for this delivery.

MADISON: --(laughs)--She's eating the towel or something.

LISA: Yeah, she grabbed the towel.

1997 LISA: (??) sit down for the baby because it was laying in mud, but I guess it really doesn't matter, does it?

LISA: You can tell I grew up in the city.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: I don't know much.

1997 LISA: Sound better! Okay, she dropped it!

LISA: That was her placenta.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: You, you have to time that, like you need to know [00:08:00] how long it took her to drop.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Because if it takes a while, it could mean that she's retained part of the placenta.

1997 LISA: I can't believe I missed it!

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: We pulled right up, you can see my car over there.

LISA: Oh yeah, I still have the headlights on.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: I bet the car's still running.

1997 LISA: So Kevin pulled around, I had a terrible headache and I was just getting in the car.

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: But I hoped she didn't have it tonight. Kevin said she always delivers in the morning. He thought she would deliver Sunday morning.

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: And we checked her. Kevin got up last night and checked her and I checked her the night before and I took Friday off and--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: Here it is Saturday night.

LISA: Oh, he doesn't like that, he's getting an [00:09:00] enema.

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: Did you do it? Did you do it?

KEVIN: Yeah.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: Okay, trying!

LISA: See how that front leg is bending?

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: That's not, that's not good.

MADISON: Yeah, but that's, um, what's very interesting to me about this video or,--

1997 LISA: --so whatcha gonna name him, Kevin?--

MADISON: --thinking about it is, I-I don't think dad can--

1997 LISA: --he looks so --(??)--

MADISON: I don't think he sees the injury or will even like, accept that he's injured.

1997 LISA: --(??)--

MADISON: Like, subconsciously.

LISA: Yeah--

MADISON: --it's not until the end of the video I think, and, yeah.

1997 LISA: --(??)--all that hair around his face.

LISA: Ugh! Now that I see it bending, it just makes me cringe.

1997 LISA: I've never seen that before.

LISA: Poor guy. Yeah, I did.

1997 LISA: [00:10:00] Look, he's got a little goatee. Ooh, ooh! Did they hurt themselves doing that?

KEVIN: --(??)--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: That's not the bin where she broke her water--

MADISON: Because at first, you know, it's normal for foals to stumble like that, right? So--

LISA: Oh, yes!

MADISON: There's not--

LISA: --yes--

MADISON: --very concerning, but it's like, aren't, they're supposed to get up in like, the first thirty minutes, right?

LISA: I think--

1997 LISA: --try to dry you off--

LISA: --they have to nurse in the first hour. --(clears throat)--I, I honestly did not know that leg was deformed at the time. I thought it was just normal, but now that I'm looking at it, you can see how much--

1997 LISA: --so this little, um--

LISA: --how much thicker that joint is.

MADISON: Yeah, yeah, you can--

LISA: --and how it's--

KEVIN: --he came--

LISA: --listen, this horse, we took him to NC State. They casted him while he grew. We had to take him back when the cast got too [00:11:00] small. They, I think we did it three or four times, Madison. And,--

1997 LISA: --just because I'll never see another horse have a baby.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --he--

1997 LISA: --when I took Friday off.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: Can you imagine being out here right now with five dogs, six dogs?

KEVIN: (??)

LISA: Again, with all the dogs.

1997 LISA: Because Sydney saw something was going on and she started barking.

MADISON: Sydney.

LISA: Sydney ended up being, um, we, we took Sydney from Uncle Tony. She was a Blue Heeler.

MADISON: Yeah I remember. OK, but what about?

1997 LISA: (??)

LISA: Oh, the leg? We took him, yes. We took him about three or four times, which meant that we had to take Chloe with him because she was still nursing.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: So it was a big ordeal. But he was never going to be --(ringing)-- a stallion or a show [00:12:00] horse. I, your dad really wanted to ride him and maybe do some showmanship with him. And, but, we, he had, um, a friend in the horse world that needed a teaser horse to get the other female, the mares to ovulate.

1997 LISA: Are they normally like that?

LISA: And he donated her--him to her and he lived a great long life.

MADISON: That's, I remember you saying that.

LISA: Yeah, and I was really happy about that because he, anybody else would probably put him down. He was, I mean, I don't want to say he was worthless, but he--

1997 LISA: --really is.

KEVIN: (??)

MADISON: Well, wasn't it, he also had a really good temperament, right?

LISA: Very good. Oh, so sweet. And [00:13:00] that's one of the things she told your dad was he, he was so sweet for being um, a stat--you know, essentially he was a stallion. He wasn't gelded and um--

1997 LISA: --I just want to make sure, yeah--

LISA: And, and she had a nurse mare operation, Madison, so it was really important that she kept her mares having babies so then, if they needed to nurse a foal where it's mom died or--

1997: --(??)--gloves, honey?

LISA: -- couldn't nurse--

1997 LISA: --well--

LISA: --And that's a really important operation to have. I think this is maybe when your dad's realizing his leg, you know, he's not going to get up.

MADISON: Yeah, yeah, because now it's 9:55.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: And it was like, what, 9:08 when you started recording?

LISA: Yeah. No, I think it was [00:14:00] 9:40.

MADISON: Oh.

LISA: You'll, you'll have to check that, but, um--

MADISON: I think it was maybe 9:08, 'cause it's not continuous. There have been jumps, I think--

LISA: --oh, okay--

MADISON: --where you paused it and then started to play again.

LISA: --(clears throat)--Okay.

1997 LISA: He's pulling you down. Wait a minute, I don't want to (??) you, I don't think you want to pick him up on the video.

MADISON: --(laughs)--you're like, zooming in on something.

1997 LISA: --in the field next to you.

LISA: Was it Superstar we were talking about?

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: And Superstar was Carla's horse, right?

LISA: Yes. Yes.

1997 LISA: Kevin, tell story. You put Chloe in here, what, a week ago?

KEVIN: --(??)--three weeks ago.

1997 LISA: Was it three weeks? No.

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: Two weeks. Two weeks ago. What'd she do? She didn't wax her-- [00:15:00]

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: --she bagged up really big. And then Kevin moved here over here (??) stall. And she (??), she (??)

KEVIN: --(??)--

LISA: --(laughs)--

KEVIN: --(??)--

MADISON: Yeah, now I think he's starting to--

1997 LISA: --(??)--so bad.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: --because he's pulling the legs out.

1997 LISA: But her bag shrunk up!

MADISON: What do you mean her bag shrunk up, like the belly?--

1997 LISA: --(??)-- Superstar--

LISA: Yeah, so their bag--

1997 LISA: --bag--

LISA: --is um,--

1997 LISA: --moved her back in the large pasture--

LISA: --the, the bag of, uh, milk--

MADISON: --oh, okay--

LISA: That the teats are, you know, connected to and they, they get, it, gets full right before they foal.

1997 LISA: Honey!

LISA: So she had bagged up and then it shrunk, so she kind of had us, gave us a false [00:16:00] start there. And then waxing up is when the actual teats will get a little wax on them.

1997 LISA: Well, I wouldn't think I came home and saw this part at least.

LISA: And they'll, then they'll start dripping and when they're dripping milk then they'll, then it's, it's almost, you know, hours. You're hours away.

1997 LISA: So I ran out there without the battery on the camera. Yelled at Kevin--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --for not--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --no,--

LISA: --I said it's always, and your dad said 'It's always Kevin's fault' --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Oh my gosh, we're not even married yet.

MADISON: I know. That was also a, a bit of a shock is like, you guys are kind of fighting like, the whole time.

LISA: We are --(laughs)--we are bickering, aren't we?

MADISON: --(laughs)--Yeah.

1997 LISA: --(??)--Chloe

LISA: But we're not angry.

MADISON: No, you're not like fighting, but yeah, you are, you're both kind of saying things like--

LISA: --yeah--

MADISON: --that are a little pointed.

1997 LISA: I would have liked to have seen this --(??)--

LISA: Oh, very much, and bantering.

MADISON: Yeah. How long were you together at this point?

1997 LISA: Oh, that's why I meant you should have hollered.

LISA: See how bossy I already, um--

1997 LISA: --I was thinking get rid of the dogs so Chloe wouldn't fret. That's why I thought she was trying to stand up.

LISA: We were together, I always have to do this like, when, when Reed Denison was born. So it was August--

1997 LISA: I don't see her.

LISA: --of '96.

KEVIN: And she was having it when we pulled up, and Lisa put the dogs up--

LISA: --I think it was August of '96.

KEVIN: Of course it was my fault.

LISA: And then of course you were [00:18:00] You're born the next year. Oh, we do, we do have the cell phones, but without pictures.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Look at that old phone.

MADISON: Yeah, it's huge.

LISA: That was Dean.

1997 LISA: Call Ellen.

LISA: --(laughs)--It's like I've had a baby.

1997 LISA: He tried to tease me outside at the auction. When he got there, he said they drove by our house and he was saying we had a filly--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --teasing me because I've basically been on foal watch.

KEVIN: --(??)--

LISA: --(laughs)--It's like we're having a baby, that's so funny. We moved, um, Halloween, right on Halloween weekend, we moved of this year, of '97. We moved to [00:19:00] Midway,--

MADISON: --Hmm.

LISA: --Kentucky and live, lived on Waterford Farm and that's where I had you.

1997 LISA: --It's only ten o'clock. Oh, this clock, oh. Wayne will be up.

LISA: Oh, he just, he just said the clock was off.

1997 LISA: --(??)--Progress anyway.

MADISON: Is that Wayne Puckett that he was, that--

LISA: -- yeah, calling them, Wayne and Ellen, I don't know why they weren't together--

1997 LISA: --but right there, and there's the stall. So she must have been in the stall --(ringing)-- because I do see some...

MADISON: I still don't think he's realized something's wrong with his leg.

1997 LISA: --(??)-- start at the paddock.

LISA: That might be. Yeah, I--

MADISON: And he just, the foal looks so [00:20:00] tired. What was his name?

LISA: Um, you know, I wish I could remember that. It's not Forrest, because Forrest was our other foal. But, what did? I think we called him Buckwheat.

MADISON: That was one of the blue heeler, wasn't that Brett's blue heeler was--

LISA: Yeah, that was Brett's blue heeler.

1997 LISA: Is that one up?

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: --Oh, well then Ellen must be up.

MADISON: But you think his name was also?--

1997 LISA: --(??)--

LISA: I do. I'm trying to, I hope we say it in the video. I can't remember, but he was a buckskin.

1997 LISA: You're sure she won't step on this baby's foot? Well, what happens [00:21:00] now-

LISA: And see, he's like right up under her.

1997 LISA: No. Kevin, ooh!

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --(laughs)--That made me really nervous.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: There she goes, she's spinning around now. Pause--

LISA: --for, for wanting to be a labor and delivery nurse--

1997 LISA: --(??)-- start trying again--

LISA: --this, this was really something I was looking forward to and--

1997 LISA: --what are you going to do?

KEVIN: --(??)--

MADISON: Yeah, I mean, you're pretty vocal and expressive throughout it. You say how much you really wanted to see it and yeah--

LISA: --mhhh.

MADISON: --you keep saying how worried you are she's going to step on him.

LISA: --mhm. You know, I grew up in the city.

1997 LISA: --might actually be eleven o'clock--

LISA: --I really had never touched a horse till I met your dad. [00:22:00] I'm not even sure I'd seen one. I'm sure I saw one somewhere, but probably in Charlottesville when, when we took Julie to college, but I'd never really touched one. And, you know, all of our animals were spayed and neutered, so I'd never even, other than a hamster, I'd never seen an animal give birth.

1997 LISA: What?

LISA: --(laughs)--And I really did like his horses. I didn't like riding them. I felt, I didn't feel comfortable horseback riding because you're up so high and things are unpredictable--

1997 LISA: --please don't--

LISA: --and I didn't grow up riding horses. So, I was always really nervous, but I really liked them as animals.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: [00:23:00] As, as, and he, he had such a nice piece of property. They always had really nice pastures and a lot of area, you know, a lot of acreage to have a nice life. And this is, about Oxford and Henderson, it's about an hour, hour fifteen minutes to Raleigh-Durham. So when I started doing clinical research, I would commute to Durham.

1997 LISA: That's what the house looks like after I do this, got five muddy dogs in there. Dylan's probably up on the bed.

LISA: [00:24:00] --(laughs)--

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: Yay, oh wait!

LISA: --(laughs)--your dad would remember his name much better, quicker. He always remembered horses' names.

1997 LISA: Not as quickly.

LISA: He still has his angel feet on, can you see, the little white?--

MADISON: --I think, I think at one point you zoom in on them. You may be about to do that in the video.

LISA: Okay.

1997 LISA: --(??)--baby?

KEVIN: Yeah--(??)--

1997 LISA: Oh, really? Right, because she let me rub him and--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: --come right over and start rubbing on him right away.

LISA: Of course, I've learned all of this from your father.

MADISON: Like, everything you're telling me now? Or--

1997 LISA: --(??)--

MADISON: --like, what you're saying in the video?

LISA: Yeah, uh, bagging up, waxing [00:25:00] up, the angel feet.

MADISON: Yeah.

1997 LISA: Really? Is it hard?

LISA: I had a medical bag ready--

1997 LISA: --(??)--

LISA: --with a, you know, with old towels--

1997 LISA: --(??)-- and we had to use um, Betadine, which is like an iodine on his umbilical cord.

MADISON: There, there's the angel feet.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: Blech, blech!

KEVIN: --(??)--

1997 LISA: --but does it hurt?

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --(laughs)--

1997 LISA: That comes out of their hoof, so that they can protect the uh, mother in utero. --(??)--

MADISON: It's also, yeah, in that shot, you can see the blood on the ground.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: That's--

LISA: --I can't remember. Do I show the placenta?

MADISON: I don't think you do, but that's also, it's, because I remember watching this--

1997 LISA: --(??)--

MADISON: --with you when you first digitized these and I forgot it was at night. So, when you told me it was really [00:26:00] dark, so I may not like the video, it's just interesting how you remember things, you know?

LISA: Mhmm. He does, I say something about, he looks like a donkey, and he kind of does.

MADISON: Yeah, and he just looks really like, tired to me too, or kind of sad.

LISA: Mhmm. --(laughs)--They do get tired. It's a lot.

MADISON:

Like it's almost like, he just decides like, okay, I'm just gonna rest now. --(laughs)--

LISA: --yeah.

MADISON: But he should be getting up.

LISA: Yeah, he's uh--

MADISON: --so, was he able to nurse on her then without being able to get up? Or--

LISA: --no--

MADISON: --was he able to get up on his own, or he had to have the cast to get up?

LISA: Um, --(ringing)--No, he gets up, you'll see, I think your dad gets him up and he's probably a good eighty to a hundred pounds. [00:27:00] Um, but he did walk. I remember that without even watching the video he walked, but it just looked like that leg was going to break--

MADISON: --mhmm--

LISA: --at any moment, you know. So, I would say within a week.

1997 LISA: Have a pattern, birthing pattern proving me wrong here.

LISA: We took him to N.C. State vet school where your Aunt Julie went. But that was about an hour away in Raleigh.

1997 LISA: She had no milk. Oh, --(??)--

LISA: --(laughs)--Oh my god, we're still arguing.

1997 LISA: Yeah, you're gonna try to make it sound better--

?: That's so funny.

1997 LISA: --for the babies.

LISA: Oh, and so then the placenta will be hanging after birth and then your dad tied it [00:28:00] up. And what that does is when you kind of, well, he examined it--

MADISON: --mhmm--

LISA: --and then you tie it in a knot and it just gives it more weight to, to naturally come off.

1997 LISA: He's going to be a pretty horse, Kevin. I think you should keep him. And um, I'll keep Cedar. Imagine if we brought them with them one day. --(??)--

LISA: My sister, Jennifer, oh! We named him Forrest, Madison.

MADISON: Oh is, did you just say that in the video?

LISA: No, I thought Forrest was Cedar, [00:29:00] but Cedar, our other foal, Cedar is our other foal, and that's the foal that Jennifer ended up taking, my sister, when we moved. But, but this is Forrest. That's right. I didn't say it in the video and now I remember we called him Forrest because when he ran he looked kind of funny and so we--

MADISON: --oh--

LISA: --that movie run Forrest, you know, run. And I remember saying, 'Run Forrest, run!' -- (laughs)-- because I was so happy for him to run when we thought, you know, when we first took him to NC State, Kev, Kevin, your dad, had me completely prepared that they would tell us to put him down. And that was one of the solid options because he was, he was just, [00:30:00] your dad used to call it a pasture ornament, meaning they're just standing in, you know, they're just standing out there in the pasture and they can't, you can't ride them, you can't breed them. So, yeah, that was Forrest. For a minute, or more than a minute, I thought that was the other, because we had two foals. Well, Cedar was born another time when I wasn't living with your dad, I think we were dating but this is, I have, I have now moved to North Carolina and was living with your dad when this happened so um, and I don't know, is that the end of the video, or?

MADISON: I guess so, you're just seeing the like, gray, static?

LISA: Static, yeah.

MADISON: I'll let it run until the end, but yeah, I think that may be the end.

LISA: Yeah. And I probably have more video of him, um, but it was, it was a really exciting night and I was obviously disappointed because it's the build up, anticipation, getting up, we would get up, we would take turns getting up in the middle of the night to check her and, and it was exciting for a city girl like me. I was excited about it and that was, it was truly one of those things where, um, yeah, I don't want to say opposites attract, but I knew nothing about this kind of life, farm life, large animal life. And so it was, I [00:32:00] loved learning--

MADISON: --mhmm--

LISA: --about the horses. I loved taking care of the horses. Yeah, it was a, it was a nice time, um. For me, I remember that being a happy time, you know?

MADISON: Mhmm. You said in the video, you were like, 'I'm never going to be able to see a horse--

LISA: --(laughs)--

MADISON: --have a baby.

LISA: I know, because he wasn't going to breed, Chloe was older, and I, I think we had discussed he wasn't going to breed her again. So to me, I, I didn't see us leaving North Carolina to come to Kentucky.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: So, he, must have gotten the offer in the fall. And then we moved [00:33:00] to Midway, Kentucky, but. And that was just happenstance. He was not looking for a job. He had a friend in the horse industry that he knew um, reach out and say, 'Would you be interested in managing a horse farm in Kentucky?', and of course, your dad was in the pig industry and um, working for a division of Smithfield Foods called Carol's Foods, and they had that line of pork that was the lean generation pork. So he was on the genetics team and ironically, he had to go to several rural North Carolina farms to make sure that those hogs, well, sows, stayed lean enough to breed. [00:34:00] And so, that was his job for many years. That's he, he's, that was his job when I met him and he, he stunk really bad --(laughs)--.

MADISON: I remember you saying that.

LISA: Yeah, uh, my brothers called him the pig man--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --um, because when you work in the hog industry, even if you're not on the farm, like, two, three days later, if your dad --(ringing)--got really sweaty, he, that smell would come out of his pores.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Yeah, he still was stinky, um, but I got used to it.

MADISON: I remember you saying you would make him take a shower as soon as he got home before you would talk to him.

LISA: Yep, yeah, it was bad, if you've ever smelled a hog farm. But yeah, so his dream, he, you know, he grew up, you know, your dad grew up with horses and showing horses and he was on [00:35:00] the equine judging team at the University of Kentucky. And so when this offer came for him to manage a thoroughbred horse farm, beautiful over eight-hundred acre farm in

Midway, Kentucky breeding race horses. Um, yeah, it was like a, you know, an opportunity you don't pass up. And thankfully I had a career that's mobile--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --and um, I said yes. And to me, I thought Kentucky was a little further, like maybe where Kansas is. I really had, I had never, the furthest I had gone was West Virginia.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And I was twenty, what was I then, in '97? [00:36:00] What does that make me, twenty-seven, twenty-eight?

MADISON: Twenty-nine.

LISA: No, twenty-nine. Yep.

MADISON: Or, no, in '97? Thirty-one.

LISA: Hmm. You're right. Because, yep, you're right. That was totally right when you do the math. So yeah, um, I had never really left, you know, gone on really big trips or um, been to, of course, the Outer Banks and I had skied, snow skied in West Virginia. I had been to Maryland. Jennifer lived in Maryland.

MADISON: I thought you went to Colorado to ski one time, didn't you?

LISA: Oh, yeah, that was, sorry, I guess I am, that, I'd forgotten. My first boyfriend took [00:37:00] a job in Idaho Falls, Idaho. And he flew me out there on my spring break in nursing school. And we did, we snow skied in um, Montana and Idaho. Yeah, Big Sky, Montana. I can't, I think it's something Grand Targhee, Idaho, I think is the mountain we skied on. We snowmobiled through Yellowstone. Yeah, so I had been on a trip, sorry. Um--

MADISON: But still, that's not like, yeah, at ton--

LISA: Moving, yeah, moving, yeah. So, we packed everything up into a horse trailer. Uh, he gave away his horses and uh, sent Cedar to my sister, sent Forrest over to the nurse mare uh, operation. [00:38:00] I think Ellen took Chloe. And I think by the time we left, Superstar had passed. Oh no, I think maybe, I think Joyce took him back. So, um, yeah. That was kind of it. That was kind of the start.

MADISON: Mhmm. I think that's cool too, that you bought the camera for this event and like this video, and then that's, 'cause that's why I'm doing this project is, I think it's interesting that, you know, you're the one recording all of these videos and taking all these photos that we have. But yeah, like, you're not in them because you're the one that's behind the camera, so--

LISA: --right, right.

MADISON: --that's really neat. I mean, I liked this video for various reasons, uh, but I think that makes it even cooler that you bought the camera for this.

LISA: Yeah, and it becomes the same camera that recorded your birth --(laughs)--.

MADISON: --(laughs)--yeah, that's cool to think about.

LISA: Yeah, and I still have it. I still have that camera.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: But yeah, and back then it was, it was, I don't know how much it cost, but they were expensive. So it was like a, you know, something you don't just go buy on a whim. And I, I, you know, my family likes to take pictures and document things. And my dad had a little video camera back--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --way back in the '70s. And so, I kind of grew up in a family that liked documenting--

MADISON: --hmm.

LISA: --events, which I never really saw them as history--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --but [00:40:00] I'm so thankful because you've seen our home videos--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --and, you know, even way back to the 50s with my mom and my siblings when they were little. So yeah, I think I got that interest from them--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --and enjoyed watching the old videos. And I mean, the one that still kills me is the one, the recording where my dad sent recordings from Vietnam.

MADISON: Oh, I don't know if I've seen those or know about those.

LISA: Yeah, we'll have to get John to play them. I'm pretty sure he played it but you girls were younger. Um, my dad sent, he recorded himself speaking and sent these tapes to my mom.

[00:41:00] And in one of them, it's John's birthday. And I don't think he sings happy birthday, but he, you know, it, it, it gets you emotional because he, you know, he says happy birthday to his son, and. And you know, my dad, no one knew if they were coming home.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: But I think because recording and sending your voice message was important to my dad, he did that. And then my mom recorded her and the kids and sent him one, you know.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: I don't know how many they did, but of course, we don't hear my mom's. [00:42:00] But we, we had my dad's because she had that, --(ringing)-- you know what I mean? I don't, I don't think my mom's made it back from Vietnam.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: So, but yeah.

MADISON: That's really interesting to think that, yeah. I, I don't think most people would consider that technology was able to do that. Or, you know, that's just like a very early form of, like you're saying, like sending a voice message or--

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: Sending a video.

LISA: It really was.

MADISON: But you had to do it analog. And I wonder, yeah, like, if that cost a lot of money or, yeah, how they did that.

LISA: I don't, I'll have to ask John and, um, and honestly, the fact that it got there, 'cause he was in such a remote location.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: [00:43:00] The fact that he got it through all of the war um, is a miracle in itself, really.

MADISON: Yeah, and it--

LISA: --But what a gift, though. You know, what a gift to get that. You know, John would have been fourteen or thirteen or fourteen years old and get to hear your dad say happy birthday when you're probably very, very scared for his circumstances,--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: -- you know?

MADISON: Yeah. Yeah, I forget the age, because the Vietnam War, it was like '68, right?

LISA: No, it started '62, three. [00:44:00] Um, let me Google that.

MADISON: But it also makes me think, because your parents got engaged over telegram, right, or?

LISA: Yes, I have that telegram.

MADISON: So that's interesting too, this kind of through line of them sending each other, you know, correspondence or media.

LISA: Uh-huh.

MADISON: Oh, why did I? To '74.

LISA: Okay, the war, but we got involved in '65.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: And he left early, well, my mom had me January '66 so he'd obviously gotten her pregnant before he left.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: So he left in early '65. And um, so yeah--

MADISON: So he was there when you were born?

LISA: He, he came home right before, I think, and then he went back for a second tour, and I'll have to ask Uncle John, I think it was '70, '71? Yeah. Maybe even earlier than that, but yeah. Crazy times. My mom was so stressed out with five kids and she, I remember her telling me very clearly she would not turn the TV on because the [00:46:00] news stations would show video from the war zones and dead bodies. She said it was very common for, you know, like a, an NBC News correspondent to film just like, all this carnage and she said you wouldn't know if that was your loved one or not. They didn't zoom in, you know, I doubt they, they showed faces, but she didn't want my siblings to see the death, you know, the, the, the war videos and so she wouldn't, she wouldn't turn the TV, allow them to turn the TV on, especially at dinner time when they would have the news. Back then, they only did the news like once a day at dinner time. So, yeah, I vividly remember her telling me that. And it, it painted a picture for me of how frightening it must have been to be a [00:47:00] single parent.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: Not, you know, not knowing um, and I'm, and I'm sure, hearing from her officer's wives friends that, you know, she was very aware people weren't coming home and the death toll numbers, you know? So, yeah, a lot, and then and that's why my grandmother came from England and stayed with us. And that's why she's in the picture of me turning one, because she stayed with my mom for like the whole year that my dad was in Vietnam. Uh, she or, you know, when he went back. So I guess he went back after I was born and um, Grandma was there to help.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: [00:48:00] Yeah. I don't know if you heard Auntie Gill say, but she doesn't know why my mom decided to have children because she never found her to be very maternal. --(laughs)--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: And I said, 'I agree with you!' --(laughs)--

MADISON: Yeah, well, I was going to ask, yeah, if Nan was more emotional support than physical support, butt-

LISA: Yeah, she was a nanny. She, I think my mom just kind of shut down and was kind of possibly non-functioning --(laughs)--.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And--

STUMPY: --(meows)--

LISA: --and, and Gran, we called her Grandma. Um--

MADISON: --oh.

LISA: --my cousins, yeah, my [00:49:00] cousins call her Nan, but um, Grandma was there to take care of us. Feed, feed us, take care of us, take care of me, probably especially.

MADISON: Mhmm. But --(ringing)-- her, like they weren't particularly close, like your mom and her mom, right?

LISA: No, no. Um, and it's funny, I don't know if my dad--

STUMPY: --(meows)--

LISA: --asked her to come--

MADISON: --hmm.

LISA: --or because I, I really can't see my mom asking her to come.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: So it must have been my father--

MADISON: --or maybe--

LISA: --out of--

MADISON: --yeah.

LISA: --out of concern.

MADISON: Yeah. But then it is interesting, it's like your mom and Auntie Gill, they'll both be, you know, they'll put on this front that they're like hardened or, you know, they don't care. But

then it's like, they're naming their kids [00:50:00] like, the same names or like, after each other and,--

LISA: Right, right. Yeah, um, yeah. My mom didn't show a lot of emotion except for anger.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: She was, she was good at that. But yeah, she, I never saw her cry.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Um--

STUMPY: --(meows)--

LISA: --and like I told you, neither of them told me, I don't know if I've ever asked my siblings, I think I asked Julie once, but can't remember her answer, but neither parent told me they loved me. It was just something we didn't say. And I certainly never said it to my siblings. And, you know, it wasn't until my dad was declining that my coworker said, I, I, told her that. And she said, 'Oh my gosh, Lisa, you have to tell your father [00:51:00] you love him.' And I said, 'I really don't think I can without crying'. It just felt like such an emotional thing to say. And she said, 'You have to say it. You just, even if he doesn't say it back, you got to say it.'. So I did. I, he was very sick and I was, he didn't make it to the bathroom. And I was cleaning up his vomit, and it was after chemo, and he was very embarrassed. And he came out of the bathroom. And he went and sat in his chair. And um, at this point, they sat in separate rooms. My mom was in the living room and he was in, we called it a day room, but it was a den. And I was cleaning him up a little bit, he still had a little bit on his pants [00:52:00] and the chair and he said something to the effect of, 'I'm sorry you have to do this'. And I joked because, you know, it's easier to joke than to be serious. And I said, 'Oh, well, you paid, you paid good money for this. You sent me to nursing school'.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And I made a big joke and, and so I was cleaning up, I remember I wasn't looking at him, I was looking down, so I must have been cleaning the floor. And I said, 'You know I love you, Dad, right?' --(pause)-- And he said, 'I know, honey.'. And then I quickly just, you know, picked up everything, all the towels and things, and I took them out into the garage and I stepped, there's a [00:53:00] door out of the garage. I remember stepping out and just basically crying my eyes out on the side of the house. It felt good to say it. But I kind of wanted him to say it back. But I know he did. I've had people ask me, 'How do you know they did?' And I said, 'Well, they took care of me, you know?' They had a roof over my head, they provided, you know, all the basics. And my mom was a thoughtful gift giver. They showed love in different ways. You know, I'd show up at my dad's work. He'd give me twenty dollars for gas. [00:54:00] He always gave me, you know, my siblings think I was the favorite--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --because I was the baby, but, um, and maybe I was--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --I didn't feel that way. I didn't feel like I got anything extra. But I, I loved him so much. He was, he was everything to me, he, and he was such a good man. I wish you had met him. He was, everybody thought so highly of him, he was very, um, held in very high regard by everyone who knew him. Just a upstanding citizen. [00:55:00] Um, always did the right thing. Well, except, except for spanking us, but that was like the norm back then. And, and I mean, he, he grew up so poor that, yeah, to get where he was, was really remarkable.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And I just feel like he didn't have a very happy life.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Other than us, other than, he very much loved his kids um, and was very proud of us. I mean, you know, you've seen the picture in the house. One of my favorite pictures is him kissing me on my graduation day.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: [00:56:00] And that smiling one of him at, they call it a pinning ceremony when I got my nurse's pin. Um, it's kind of like your baccalaureate for high school. And um, that smile on his face. I think Julie got that shot.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: Um, and then that month that I graduated, he was diagnosed with lung cancer.

MADISON: Hmm. How, uh, or like, what was the timeline that day that you told him you loved him? Like, was he in hospice at that point or?

LISA: He never would agree to hospice.

MADISON: But basically he was on home hospice.

LISA: Yeah, I we, we didn't. I was his home health --(ringing)--nurse. So, [00:57:00] he didn't need much um, until the very end and that's when, um, you know, Madison, I'm going to say a couple weeks, a month after I said that. I was doing some deep, deep uh, lung suctioning and his secretions were so thick that he was turning cyanotic when I was suctioning him, like his nail beds would go blue and his lips would go blue. And I finally was like, you know, he was just gurgling and I, I called my brother David to come. And we talked outside and I said, 'I can't do it anymore. Um, I think he needs to go to the hospital.' and I said, 'I don't think he's going to. [00:58:00] agree.' And uh, because my dad did not want to die at the hospital, he wanted to die at

home. And so, David went in and then, into the living room, and I went in and we did have a home health nurse we could call for emergencies. And so she, my mom agreed to call the home health nurse and she came out and she told my mom that he needed to go to the hospital. And uh, to get, they needed to give him, you know, Lasix, diuretics and pull some of that fluid, or he was just going to drown in his own secretions.

And so the ambulance came and I wanted, I, his blood pressure was low. Um, [00:59:00] I, I wanted to ride in the ambulance and the ambulance guy, like, treated me like I was stupid and said um, 'You know, ma'am. Not a good idea. You know if he codes...' because they were freaked out that my dad was a full code. They couldn't believe that he wasn't on hospice and that he was a do not resuscitate. But my dad, his thought process was he was a colonel in the army, he wasn't going to give up. And to him that was giving up and, so I said, 'I'm a nurse, I'm aware. I'm fully aware.' because, you know, the, the EMT said, you know, if we start chest compressions, he's so frail, we might crack a rib, you know, he might not make it, you know, blah, blah, blah. And I said, I'm, I was obsessed with my dad not dying alone, without one, you know, [01:00:00] someone with him; family. And I said, 'I know that.'

So I rode, they let me on the ambulance. I get to the hospital before everyone else. So, I, I'm the one giving like, the history. And the ER was like, 'He's a full code?' And I said, 'Yes, he's a full code.' And they, they were freaking out. So, they send us up to the oncology floor. Now it's like, middle of the night, one, two in the morning and the floor nurses call his oncologist and they tell me I need to go to the nurse's station to speak to the oncologist on call and it wasn't my dad's regular uh, physician, [01:01:00] but it was his partner and he proceeds to chew me out over the phone, that we are being unrealistic as a family, that he's going to die, it is imminent he's going to die, and we're holding on to a, you know, an unrealistic hope, la la la. I said, 'It is not my choice. My, my father is here and he's alert, you can ask him.' And I said, 'And my mother is his power of attorney. So, you're going to have to speak to one of them. But I'm just telling you, these are his wishes and he's still alive.' And that pissed him off. Man, he was so mad, one, that he got woken up and then, the very next morning he was there at the hospital. And he [01:02:00] called my mother from, you know, after he saw my dad. And I don't know what their conversation was, Madison, but my mother made, my mother made him a do not resuscitate.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And he lived, that was Sunday or like, early Monday morning and his birthday was the following Sunday. He was, he always said he wanted to live to be, he wanted to get to sixty-five. He was diagnosed at sixty. And they gave him eighteen months to live. And he was sixty-four, gonna turn sixty-five and at five something a.m. on his 65th birthday he passed away. --(pause)-- [01:03:00] Couldn't, couldn't even make it up.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: John, John had, we, we celebrated his birthday the day before because it was Saturday. John made a pecan pie. He brought it to the hospital. Everybody came to the hospital. We all sang him happy birthday. Um, he was kind of in and out because of course they were giving him morphine. But I saw his pulse rate go up and he got really diaphoretic, really sweaty. So, I knew he could hear us. And so, after we sang happy birthday, I said, hey everybody, you know, why don't you? There was a waiting room at the end of the hall. I said, 'Hey, everybody, why don't...', there was a waiting room at the end of the hall. 'Hey, why don't?', there were conversations going on. I said, 'Hey, why don't, why don't some of you go down to the end of the hall? Um, Dad, Dad's little [01:04:00] worked up.' And so, like Little Johnny and them went down the hallway and I got Dad a little more comfortable. Um, I got a washcloth for his forehead and then everybody left and uh, Jennifer had come into town and Julie, they lived out, out of, out, you know, Jennifer up in Pennsylvania and Julie was in vet school, but they were there. And David and I and Keith had been staying the night. So, somebody was always there with Dad during the day, at night. So, Jennifer and Julie asked, could they stay Saturday night to give me and David a break? And I said, yeah, you know, I, I don't care who's there, really. I just want somebody there. And I wasn't [01:05:00] being bossy, but um, and Little Johnny asked if he could stay. He really, he adored my dad. So, Jennifer and I had given him a bath Saturday morning and he had a really sustained period of apnea. I thought he was going to pass Saturday. He didn't. So, we went home, Keith and I, and they called me. And I, to this day, do not regret that. I just, I'm, and I'm actually kind of happy. Maybe dad was holding on for them, you know?

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: Maybe he was holding on 'til [1:06:00] Julie got there.

MADISON: Yeah. I think that is, yeah.

LISA: So, Julie was holding one hand, Jennifer was holding the other, and little Johnny was holding on to his feet. And then we got dressed, we lived right down the road from the hospital not even, maybe twenty minutes and David was forty across the river and um, I called Father Kerry, the Catholic priest who had married us.

I think I've told you this story, he came uh, September, um, because my dad died September 18th, um, and, he was wearing his, he was a Franciscan priest, [01:07:00] and he was wearing his brown shroud with his rope belt and his Birkenstock sandals and he, it was so early in the morning. I was standing outside the room because the nurses, the nurses were in there taking some of the equipment and things, you know what I mean? Getting him, his body ready. And here comes Father Kerry. He looked like the Grim Reaper coming down the hallway. Like these are really, really long hallways and with his hood, you know, and everything and I know those nurses were like, what is going on? Their faces were kind of shocked, but, uh, you know, it's just his, just his attire for his career. [01:08:00] And I was, oh my God, I'm so thankful. I felt like in a way, that was like, divine intervention that he married us and, in January, and this is September, same year. And he was able to be there for us at this, two pivotal moments in our

life. My father really, really liked him because he was an Air Force um, priest. And then my sister Jennifer had gone to get my mother and not too long after I was, you know, with Father Kerry and he was comforting me and Keith and my s--Julie. Um, my mom showed up and that, I'll never [01:09:00] forget how grateful my mom was that --(cries)-- a priest was there. And it was just really weird because she had such a, a messed up relationship with the Catholic Church. And, but, I think when you're raised so traditional, to know that Father Kerry gave my dad his last rites--

MADISON: --mhmm.

LISA: --was so comforting. I mean, I've never seen her so grateful to anybody in my life.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: And, I think that really did give her a lot of peace; that, that sacrament. Even though my dad wasn't Catholic. [01:10:00] And she also mentioned ,because he was military, kind of checked all the boxes, you know?

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: And we were all in the room. We all went into the room. I can't tell you what he said, but it was beautiful. He did the --(cries)-- sign of the cross on his forehead. It was just really, if I, you know, if we hadn't gotten married, I would have never developed a relationship with him and, just such a kind priest and was perfect. I've told a lot of people it was, if you're ever gonna be with someone who passed away, my dad passed away so peacefully.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: [01:11:00] And he wouldn't have at home. Like he was struggling to breathe --(ringing)-- at home. So essentially, the last five days or so, they did put him on hospice. You know, I'm sure they were giving him a large amount of morphine--

MADISON: --yeah, yeah.

LISA: --to make him comfortable. And um, and it was, it was the right thing to do.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: I thought for many months of writing a scathing letter to the oncology group and letting Dr. Matter's partner know how uncompassionate he was at a critical time in our family's [01:12:00] grief, what horrible bedside manner he had. And you know, letting them know as a nurse in the medical profession. He was, you know, crap. To me, that was like, to put me through that phone call and make me feel guilty. Like, like I couldn't see the writing on the wall when it wasn't even my decision to make.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: I just happened to be the family reporter that rode in the ambulance. Oh, but. Thankfully, whoever, I mean, I'm sure I told Keith and I'm sure I told David and they probably both told me just to calm, you know, think about it.

MADISON: [01:13:00] Yeah.

LISA: You know, give it some time, see how you feel. And then, you know, I decided I wouldn't write it, but I did feel like he was an asshole and he should not be in the profession he is in.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: Because there was no compassion there.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Yeah, and I hope um, I hope other people didn't have to go through that with him because, I, yeah, I think, I think what you want to do and the gift that is to be a chaplain or to help people transition is such a gift. I, [01:14:00] I could not do it. I'm just way too emotional and I think I would be very unhelpful. I think I would probably cry more than I, the family would want me to, and I would probably say the wrong thing.

MADISON: I think those are natural, normal fears, though. I don't know, we'll see, maybe I'll cry too much. But I also think people, I don't know, that was like when I talked with one of my professors here and told her, you know, everything with Dad dying, like, she started crying and I feel like that was actually, you know, I felt more like, seen or appreciated--

LISA: --mhmm.

MADISON: --in that conversation than a lot of the other conversations I had been having.

LISA: Yeah, I get that. [01:15:00] I, uh, we were putting Penny down. And of course it was the vet, I think I told you, it was the vet who was Dad's friend, um sort of friends, like he worked with her husband who was an equine vet. And then he, that's when Penny was having all of that incontinence and he thought it was a UTI. So, Doctor Wells's husband said, 'Why don't you take her into my wife? She's at Scott County Animal Hospital.' And so he took, Dad took Penny to um, Christine and that's when she got diagnosed with the bladder stones.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: But Dad didn't have the money. Uh, he wasn't going to pay, he wasn't going to get the surgery, so, [01:16:00] Reese and I said we would pay. It was expensive, it was almost, it was like six-thousand something dollars. Um, so we paid and we did the follow up, like we brought her here, took care of her, took her back for her follow up appointment. So we knew Christine. And then when we switched from Buffalo Trace vet out here to Eckert we were there, I don't know, not even a year and they announced they were getting a new vet and her name was Christine Wells. And I said, 'Oh my God,' I said, 'we know Christine'. And uh, we had gone out

there with Finley because they did acupuncture. And they were just a younger group that, kind of up on the literature--

MADISON: --mhhh.

LISA: --of new things to try for Finley. So, [01:17:00] remember Christine was the one, she was the vet when we had Angel, she thought Angel was a boy! --(laughs)--

MADISON: Or a girl.

LISA: And so, yeah, a girl, that's right. And then we gave her a hard time--

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: --after that. And then I gave her back the stones because I had asked for the bladder stones. And we had those for a long time, you remember?

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: So then when she came to my vet practice, I said, 'Oh my gosh, let me give you the stones because that way if you need to show a client or your kids want to take them in for show and tell or something'. And so, um, they, they have the stones at the vet.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: And so when we took Penny in that last day, it was with Christine and she's the one who put her down. And the reason I'm telling you this is she started crying.

MADISON: [01:18:00] Yeah.

LISA: And she said, 'I feel like it's a full', she says, 'I've met, I never met a dog who was tougher than her.' And, you know, she says, 'I'm so glad, you know, I was here.' You know, kind of a full circle moment. And um, she said, 'You did everything you could for her.' And then she was crying and, and she, she, uh, they put them into a little box that looks like a coffin.

MADISON: Mhhh.

LISA: And um, she said to, the technician was going to pick her up and she said, 'No.' She said, 'I wanna, I wanna do it with --(ringing)-- dignity.' Not that the technician wouldn't have done it with dignity, but Christine wanted to lift Penny into the box. So, yeah, so the reason I'm [01:19:00] saying this is it did feel good that she cried with us.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: Because it's okay to cry. You know, it's okay to show how much you feel.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: But I felt horrible because it was the day before Easter and her kids were there --(laughs)-- they brought in, an emergency came in while we were there.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: Oh, it was, that was a really stressful day for her, too. Oh gosh, I'm sorry, I'm like, big crybaby today.

MADISON: Don't apologize. I think, well, it's like a, yeah, for me, it's an emotional video. And then I think there are obvious connections to things in both of our lives that are also emotional. So, it's [01:20:00] normal, I think.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: Or--

LISA: --yeah. --(wind chimes)-- Yeah, I think I was really excited to see that birth because it was all new to me. A lot of similarities to medicine.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: --(wind chimes)-- Especially childbirth, so.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: I was--

MADISON: Yeah, it is interesting to me how similar it seems like they are and that, you know, Dad and then kind of all the men on the Cissell side, you know, they just know that very well. So,--

LISA: Yes. Yeah.

MADISON: --or, you know, they know that better than, probably most vets or, you know, vet students and then--

LISA: --right.

MADISON: --thinking, yeah, just, they'd probably know a lot about human birth too, but they just--

LISA: Oh yeah, sure. Your dad did. [01:21:00] I mean, I didn't have to tell him anything, but he was so funny and, you know, when he passed out, when we went to see Ellen after she had uh, Carly, he passed out in the room because of just seeing the blood, like her, her changing pads, you know, the bloody, uh, sanitary pads and everything and, Slinky, get out of there! Slinky! --(whistles)-- He's teaching this puppy to go where the cats poop.

MADISON: --(laughs)--

LISA: Um, come on, Pippa! --(whistles)-- But yeah, and then of course he passed out with you and Brooke, I wouldn't even let him, like he just videoed it from a chair, I think.

MADISON: Yeah. Well, I was thinking about that in the video because you can see blood on the ground and it's like, yeah--

LISA: --he can do anything, he can do anything to a horse. Madison, at [01:22:00] Waterford, one day a mare went down, they call it a red bag. She was delivering the placenta first, which is what would have happened with Annmarie with me. And uh, she went down in the field, the bag was first. They had to do an emergency C, like Kevin did the C-sec, like he, he sliced her open. And then the vet got there and the foal lived. Of course, the mare didn't, but um, she was hemorrhaging, you know, she was dying anyways. But he came home that day and you would have thought somebody threw a bucket of blood on him.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: He was bloody from his neck down. I've never seen anything like it. We just threw his clothes away.

MADISON: Mhm.

LISA: But he, he said he can do anything to an animal. Like, he castrates, you know, they castrate them, the [01:23:00] cattle, he can do anything, um, but he can't see, and he can see his own blood sometimes, not like, you know, giving blood, he could never do that. But he can't see other people's blood, like your blood, my blood.

MADISON: Hmm. But I'm kind of, I guess I thought, well, maybe we were, because it's like, usually I pass out with my blood, right? But it's, I think I'm fairly okay with other people's.

LISA: He, he did giving blood, like if he ever had to give blood um, for like a lab test, he passed out like you. But what I mean, his blood, like once he got a really bad cut at work while he was working or at the UK (University of Kentucky) farm when he was in college and he didn't pass [01:24:00] out with that.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: But it was mostly thinking about it and also the smells, like seeing it, smelling it, those kinds of things.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: So, um, like when you cut your ankle--

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: I wasn't even sure because I was in the back with you because you were getting shocky and he was driving, but I was like, I don't even know if this is a good scenario. --(laughs)--

Because he, I just kept telling him, don't look, you know, don't, don't look back. But yeah, you're starting to get nauseous and you're very pale. So yeah, that was, in hindsight, probably not the smartest thing. I asked Carrie Thomas to watch Brooke. I can't [01:25:00] remember, I guess, yeah, we'd had Annmarie, so I guess she had to watch Annmarie too.

MADISON: Yeah.

LISA: By then. Hey, give me that! Jesus Christ. Get over here! She's eating, she found a walnut, which they're like, you know what I mean?

MADISON: They're really--

LISA: --poisonous, yeah. Come on, out of here! How does she even find that? She's so tiny though, she can get into little, little holes. You're gonna make yourself sick and die! Poisonous! --(sirens)-- All right, come on, guys! All right, honey, I won't keep you anymore, I know you've got to do school work.

MADISON: Okay, well, thank you.

LISA: You're welcome.

MADISON: For all of that. Are you okay with--

LISA: --I hope--

MADISON: --me keeping the recording of all the things we talked about after?

LISA: Oh, yes. Yes, of course.

MADISON: Okay. What was that experience like for you? Quickly.

LISA: The, the foaling?

MADISON: Or like, what? [01:26:00] I guess I'm just curious to hear, 'cause I haven't done it, like, trying to narrate, you know, a video from--

LISA: Oh, that experience!

MADISON: --twenty, almost thirty years ago, you know, that you haven't seen in a while.

LISA: Yeah.

MADISON: With your dead ex-husband. --(ringing)-- --(laughing)-- Like--

LISA: Yeah. Um, it was good, it was good memories. Yeah, I didn't feel uncomfortable. Um, it reminded me of happier times.

MADISON: Hmm.

LISA: So, it was good, you know.

MADISON: Yeah, but it didn't seem like it was difficult for you, like, to fill in the space or it seemed like you--

LISA: --no--

MADISON: --remembered a lot of the details.

LISA: Yeah, no, not of that time. That was so early in our relationship that, um, I remember that time, like, fondly, you know?

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: And I was learning so much, uh I liked that. I liked learning about his life and his horses and, you know, just being on a farm.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: It was therapy for me, really. I, I enjoyed leaving the city and going there for the weekend when we were dating, and then, of course, uh, when we decided to move in together, it just made sense for me to move there.

MADISON: Mhmm.

LISA: So yeah, it wasn't difficult at all, really.

MADISON: Okay. Well, thank you for doing that.

LISA: Mhmm.

MADISON: And--

LISA: --you're welcome.

MADISON: I hope you enjoy the rest of your Sunday. Maybe take it easy since it was emotional at times.

LISA: Yeah, [01:28:00] I've had an easy weekend. Annmarie, we just, we hung out at home yesterday and she gets off work at six. So, it'll be another, another easy night.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: All right, honey. Well, thanks for calling. Let me know if you have any other questions.

MADISON: Okay.

LISA: Alright, bye, I love you.

MADISON: I love you too.

LISA: Okay, bye.

MADISON: Bye.